Equality changes the loss and the baseline

One pair and one criterion, before weighting and division by M.

Weak-error loss

Latent state	$i \succ j$	Hold	$j \succ i$
$\theta_i > \theta_j$	0	τ	1
$\theta_i = \theta_j$	1	τ	1
$\theta_i < \theta_j$	1	τ	0

Same rows and reporting actions

Equality-neutral loss

Latent state	$i \succ j$	Hold	$j \succ i$
$\theta_i > \theta_j$	0	τ	1
$\theta_i = \theta_j$	0	0	0
$\theta_i < \theta_j$	1	τ	0

Same rows and reporting actions

Symbolic state masses

p_+ Strict forward	p_0 Equality	p_- Strict reverse

$p_+ + p_0 + p_- = 1$ | Boxes are not to scale

Expected local costs

	Weak-error	Neutral
Report $i \succ j$	$p_0 + p_-$	p_-
Hold	τ	$\tau(p_+ + p_-)$

Full-report all-withhold baseline (if feasible)

Weak-error: τ

Equality-neutral: $R_0^S = \tau T_w^S / M$

Zero neutral cost does not certify strict superiority; hold withholds a direction.